Argument Quality Rubric

Total: 25 points | Each dimension scored 1–5

Dimension 1: Claim Clarity (max 5 points)

Does the paragraph state a clear, specific, and defensible position?

Score	Anchor Description
5	Position is unambiguous, specific, and immediately identifiable.
4	Position is clear but could be slightly more precise or specific.
3	A position is present but vague or buried; requires inference to identify.
2	Position is implied but never explicitly stated.
1	No discernible position, or the paragraph contradicts itself.

Dimension 2: Quality of Evidence & Support (max 5 points)

Are claims backed by concrete reasoning, examples, data, or logical grounds?

Score	Anchor Description
5	Multiple specific, relevant pieces of evidence or reasoning. Support is concrete, not generic.
4	Evidence is present and relevant, but could be more specific or developed.
3	Some support is offered, but vague, anecdotal, or only partially relevant.
2	Very limited support; mostly assertions without backing.
1	No evidence or reasoning provided; purely opinion.

Dimension 3: Warrant & Logical Reasoning (max 5 points)

Is the logical link between evidence and claim made explicit? Does the argument hold together?

Score	Anchor Description
5	Reasoning chain is explicit and sound. Clear why evidence supports the claim. No logical leaps.
4	Reasoning is mostly clear; minor gaps in the logical chain.
3	Some reasoning present but the connection between evidence and claim is assumed.
2	Evidence and claim stated but the logical link is absent or weak.
1	No logical connection; reasoning is circular, fallacious, or incoherent.

Dimension 4: Counterargument Engagement (max 5 points)

Does the paragraph acknowledge and address an opposing view or objection?

Score	Anchor Description

5	A specific, steelmanned counterargument is acknowledged and meaningfully rebutted or qualified.
4	A counterargument is acknowledged and addressed, but not fully developed.
3	An opposing view is briefly mentioned but not engaged with substantively.
2	A counterargument is vaguely gestured at with no engagement.
1	No acknowledgment of any opposing view.

Dimension 5: Overall Persuasiveness & Coherence (max 5 points)

Taken as a whole, how structured, convincing, and rhetorically effective is the paragraph?

Score	Anchor Description
5	Argument flows logically, builds to a convincing conclusion, and would persuade a neutral reader.
4	Mostly persuasive and coherent with minor structural weaknesses.
3	Argument is followable but disjointed or only partially convincing.
2	Argument is difficult to follow; structure is unclear or contradictory.
1	Incoherent or unconvincing as a whole; the paragraph does not function as an argument.

Grader Instructions

Grade each dimension **independently**. Do not let overall impression affect individual scores.
Do **NOT** consider grammar or writing style unless it directly impedes understanding the argument.
Use only whole numbers **1–5**. No half-scores.